

Jury Data Report

2015-16 Through 2024-25

Research, Analytics, and Data

Introduction

Since fiscal year 2007, the Judicial Council of California has administered an opt-in survey to each California trial court to collect operational data on jury department performance. The survey captures metrics aligned with the National Center for Court Studies' (NCSC) 8th Trial Court Performance Measure on the Effective Use of Jurors. Courts use these metrics to streamline juror summons and qualification, and to increase the rate at which they seat juries from the available pool of jurors.

This report summarizes statewide jury metrics for the most recent reporting year and presents ten-year historical trends. It provides a comprehensive overview of jury summoning outcomes, juror availability, case type distributions, and the effectiveness of the jury selection pipeline across California's superior courts. The Judicial Council intends for these findings to support more efficient jury operations statewide and to better meet the demands of modern jury service.

Definitions

Jury Summoning

NEWLY SUMMONED. The total number of prospective jurors who received a summons to appear for jury service, whether by mail, electronic service, or other means. This figure represents the initial pool of potential jurors contacted by trial courts.

POSTPONED IN. Prospective jurors from a prior-period who had postponed their service to the current period, and are hence summoned for service in the current period in lieu of their prior-period obligation.

TOTAL SUMMONED. The total amount of jurors summoned for jury service in the current period; the summation of Newly Summoned and Postponed In.

QUALIFIED AND AVAILABLE. Prospective jurors who appear for jury service, meet all statutory and qualifications for service, and are available for potential jury selection. These individuals have not been excused, disqualified, or otherwise removed due to unavailability.

Reasons for Juror Unavailability

EXCUSED. Prospective jurors who are released from jury service due to hardship or other personal reasons. Excused jurors may be excused for a single trial or for an extended period.

DISQUALIFIED. Prospective jurors who do not meet the statutory requirements for jury service, including citizenship, language proficiency, or certain criminal history criteria.

DISMISSED. Prospective Jurors who are exempt from jury service, either for employment as a peace officer or being deceased.

UNDELIVERED. Summonses that could not be delivered to the prospective juror due to incorrect address, inability to locate the individual.

FAILURE TO APPEAR. Prospective jurors who received a valid summons but did not appear on their scheduled date without authorization.

POSTPONED OUT. Prospective jurors whose service is postponed to a future date after their initial scheduled appearance or who request postponement and whose service is deferred to a later period.

Jury Utilization

TOLD TO REPORT. The percentage of summoned prospective jurors who are instructed to physically appear for jury service. Not all summoned jurors are called to report; many complete their service by simply waiting on-call or on telephone.

SENT FOR SELECTION. The percentage of prospective jurors told to report who are actually sent to a courtroom for jury selection proceedings. Some may be released or dismissed prior to reaching the selection phase.

PANEL USED. The percentage of prospective jurors sent for selection who are ultimately assigned to a jury panel, either sworn or released during or after jury selection. This represents the final stage of the jury utilization pipeline.

Jury Trial Types and Designations

FELONY, MISDEMEANOR, CIVIL, AND OTHER. Case types distinguish the nature of the matter being tried. Felony cases involve serious criminal offenses; misdemeanor cases involve lesser criminal offenses; civil cases involve disputes between private parties or entities; and other cases include specialized proceedings.

ONE DAY JURORS. Qualified and available jurors who finish their service in one day, whether it be on call, on standby, or in person are considered one-day jurors. In-person designations indicate physical courtroom appearance, while teleconference designations indicate remote participation.

Jury utilization

Jury utilization is the proportion of total summoned jurors who are qualified and available for jury service, as specified in percentage terms below.

$$\text{Jury utilization (\%)} = \frac{\text{Available Jurors}}{\text{Available Jurors} + \text{Unavailable Jurors}} \cdot 100$$

Jury utilization is a key performance measure that reflects the efficiency of the jury summoning process and the effectiveness of courts in converting summoned jurors into usable jurors for trials.

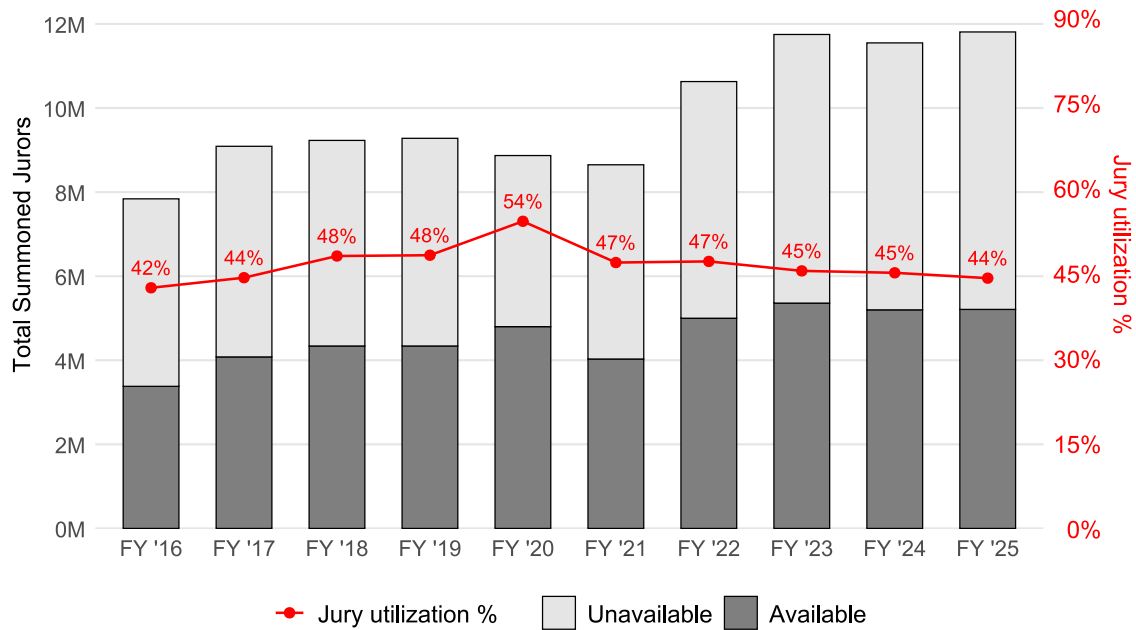


Figure 1: Jury utilization Trends

Figure 1 shows total summoned jurors having reached nearly 12 million each year since FY 2020-23. Both available and unavailable jurors increased post-2020, while utilization has remained stable. While the number of jurors summoned has increased, the percentage of those jurors who are qualified and available has not changed significantly, indicating that the increase in summons has not translated into a higher utilization of usable jurors.

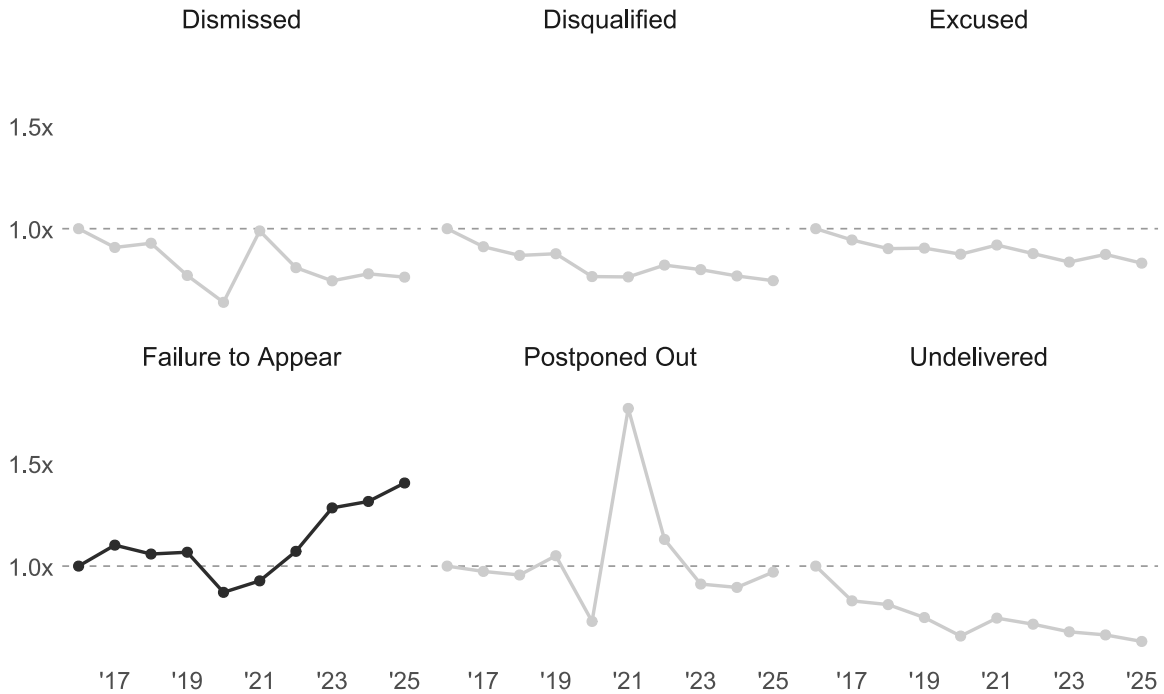


Figure 2: Unavailable Jurors — Indexed Change by Subcategory

The line charts above reveal that Failure to Appear (FTA) incidents have risen disproportionately relative to other categories of juror unavailability. Values are indexed to FY 2015–16 (the dashed baseline), with each subsequent year reflecting the proportional change from that reference point. This normalization highlights the relative magnitude of change across categories, surfacing trends in less common categories that could otherwise be hidden in raw counts. This is especially the case with unavailable categories, as

Jury Utilization

Juror Utilization is the proportion of qualified and available jurors who ultimately are required for a judge to impanel a jury in *voire dire*. The proportion is expressed by multiplying the proportion of jurors told to report, sent for selection, and ultimately used in a panel, as specified in percentage terms below.

$$\text{Jury Utilization (\%)} = \text{Told to Report (\%)} \cdot \text{Sent for Selection (\%)} \cdot \text{Panel Used (\%)} \cdot 100$$

Jury Utilization Historical Trend

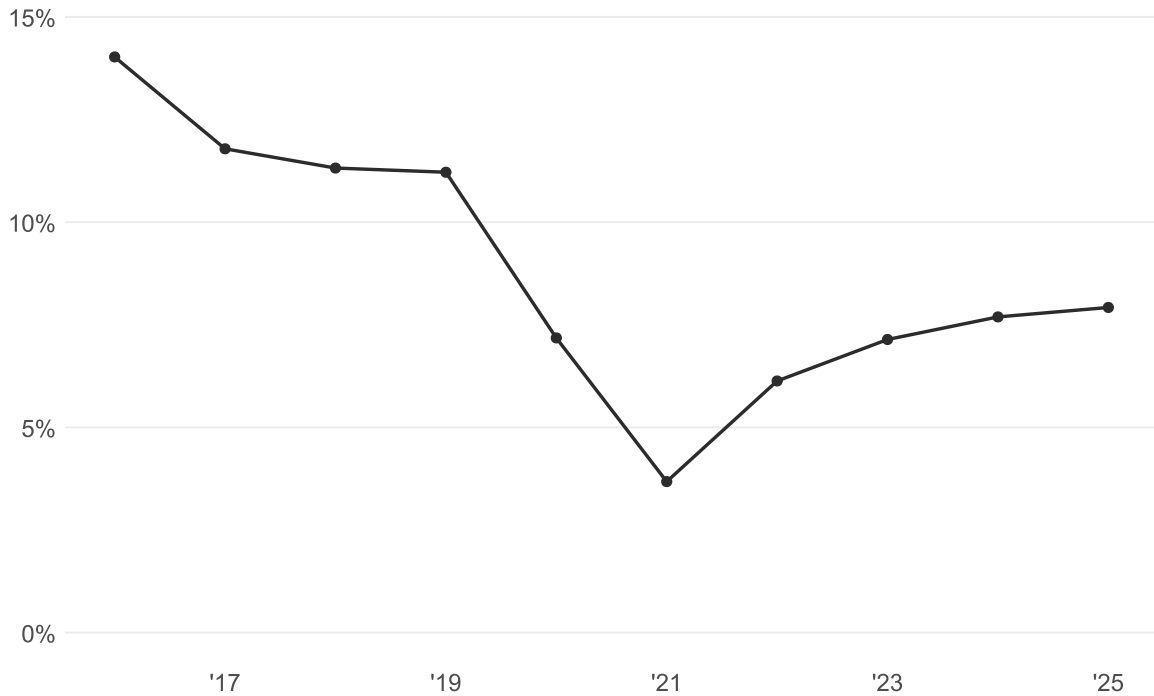


Figure 3: Jury Utilization Trend

Juror utilization has risen modestly year over year since the pandemic low, reaching 7.9% in FY 2024-25. This means that for every hundred jurors who appeared at a courthouse for service, judges ultimately questioned about eight in voir dire to either swear them onto a jury or excuse them. While this marks a clear recovery from the pandemic-era low point, utilization has not yet returned to the pre-pandemic 10-year high of 14% in FY 2015-16. While utilization measures often fall well below the nationwide average of 25%, research shows that larger courts consistently produce lower rates — courts serving populations over 500,000 average 16% nationally [1]. With California courts serving a population of over 39 million, the state's lower utilization follows this national pattern.

Percentage of jurors utilized at each stage of service

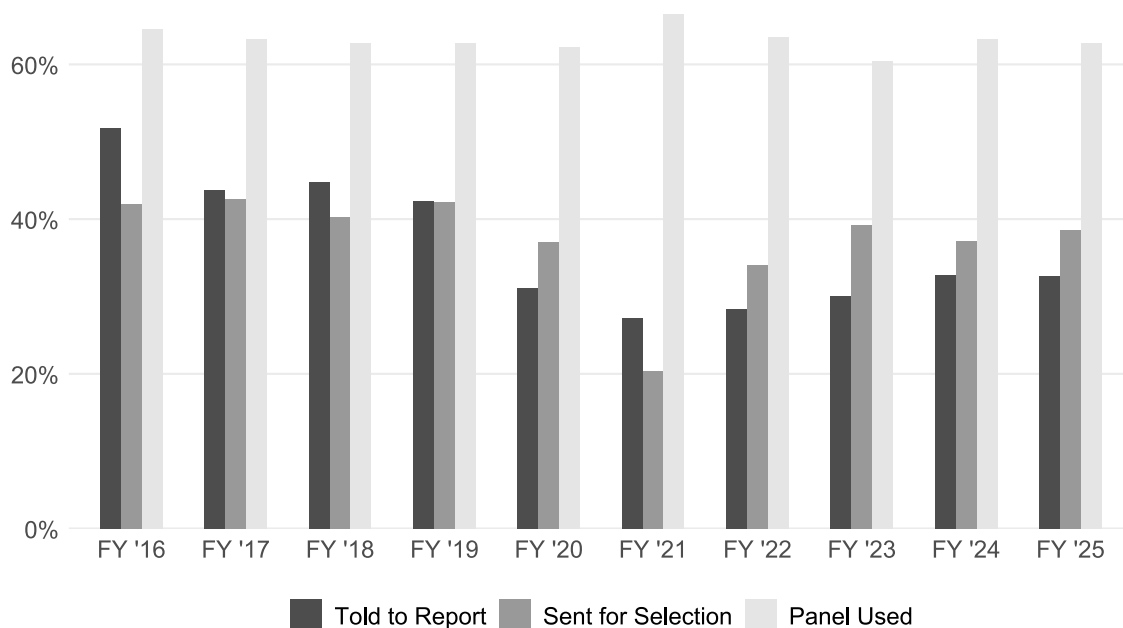


Figure 4: Jury Utilization Subcategories

Bar chart showing the percentage of summoned prospective jurors who progress through the jury utilization pipeline: told to report, sent for selection, and ultimately used in a panel. The trend shows that while Sent for Selection and Panel Used have remained relatively stable, the percentage of jurors Told to Report has notably decreased since pre-2020 levels, suggesting over-reliance on leaving jurors on telephone around leaving jurors on standby or on-call rather than instructing them to report in person.

Statewide Distribution of Utilization Components

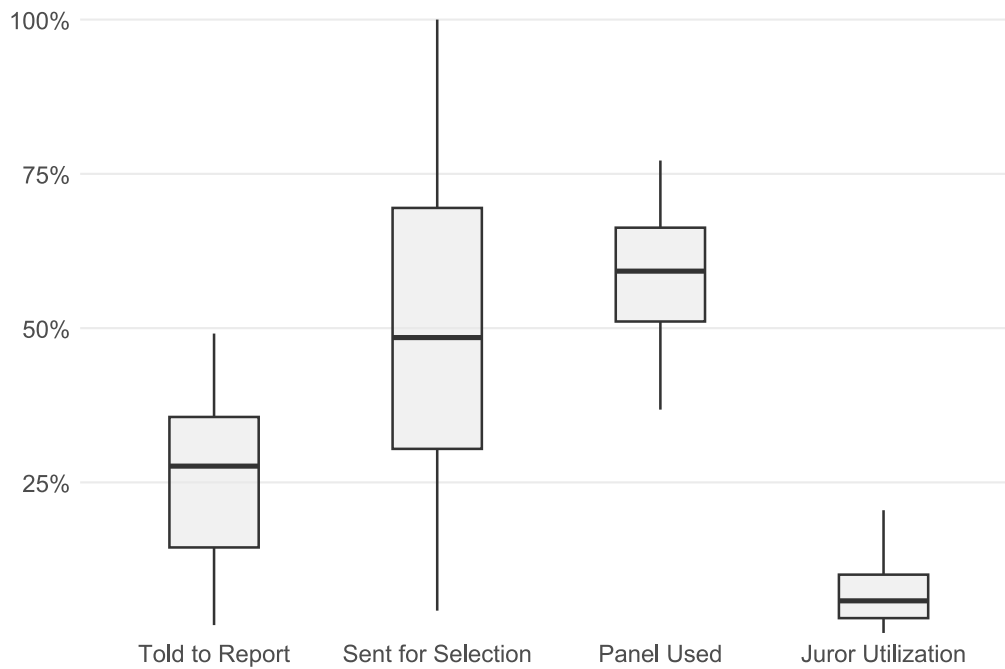


Figure 5: Distribution of Jury Utilization Components

Box and whisker plot showing the distribution of three key measures across all California courts: told to report, sent for selection, and panel used. 50% of courts fall within each respective box, with the median indicated by the horizontal line. The plot illustrates that while the percentage of jurors told to report and those used in a panel are tightly clustered, jurors sent for selection varies widely across courts, suggesting that variation in jury utilization across courts may be driven more by practices around selection than by practices around summoning or reporting.

Panel Case Types

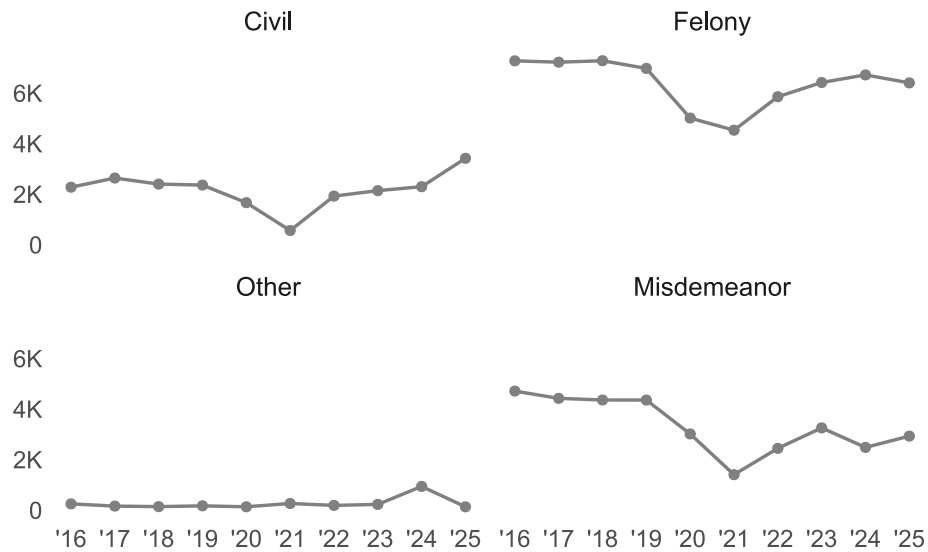


Figure 6: Panel Case Types — Historical Trend

Sworn Case Types

Line chart showing the trend in sworn jurors by case type from FY 2016 across the past 10 fiscal years.

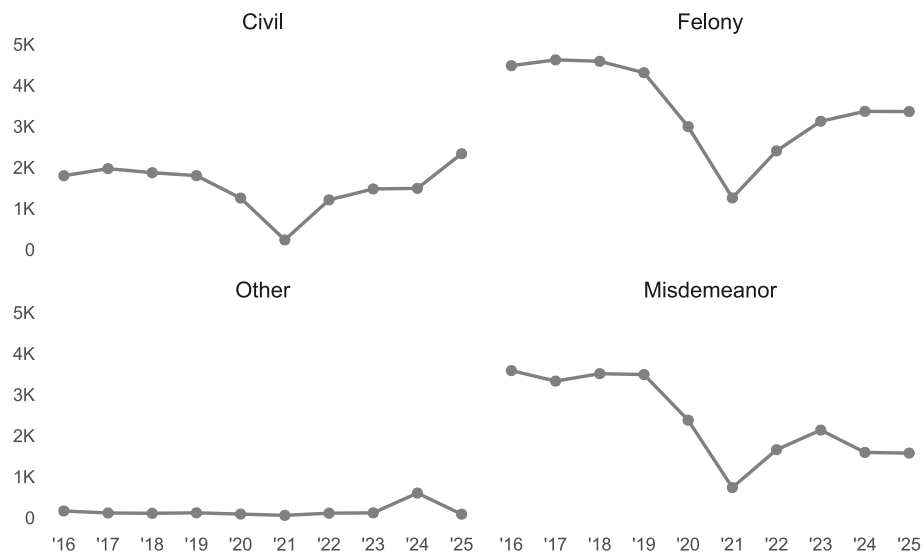


Figure 7: Sworn Case Types — Historical Trend

One Day Service Mode

Line chart showing the trend in one-day jury service by modality from FY 2016 baseline across the past ten fiscal years.

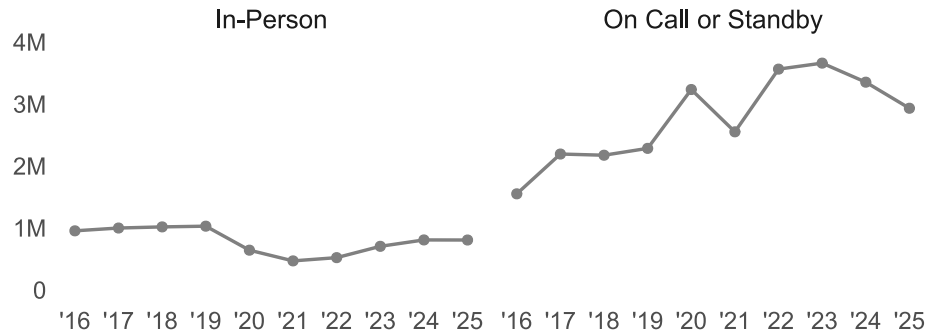


Figure 8: One-Day Jury Service Modality

Tables

Table 1: Jury utilization Summary

Fiscal Year	Summoned	Postponed-In	Available	Unavailable	utilization %
FY '25	10,898,270	914,182	5,209,750	6,595,471	44.1
FY '24	10,687,217	862,315	5,201,478	6,348,054	45.0
FY '23	10,994,630	811,407	5,357,386	6,387,714	45.4
FY '22	9,889,604	741,388	5,001,376	5,629,616	47.0
FY '21	8,222,971	453,138	4,029,425	4,620,327	46.9
FY '20	8,140,486	735,814	4,803,482	4,072,818	54.1
FY '19	8,874,412	525,213	4,342,880	4,942,656	48.1
FY '18	8,831,301	551,074	4,337,065	4,894,952	48.0
FY '17	8,762,451	475,874	4,081,120	5,012,346	44.2
FY '16	7,541,675	437,174	3,382,958	4,459,101	42.4

Table 2: Unavailable Juror Subcategories

Fiscal Year	Excused	Disqualified	Dismissed	Undelivered	Failure to Appear	Postponed Out
FY '25	1,021,780	1,148,053	45,130	779,607	3,040,714	567,418
FY '24	1,050,175	1,157,103	45,065	800,365	2,783,106	512,240
FY '23	1,027,719	1,229,969	44,049	836,697	2,777,123	533,094
FY '22	971,005	1,138,038	43,070	794,486	2,088,790	594,227

FY '21	829,952	863,830	42,904	675,168	1,476,318	758,512
FY '20	807,982	885,796	28,480	610,084	1,419,441	321,035
FY '19	884,521	1,073,867	36,297	734,186	1,839,333	488,541
FY '18	880,456	1,061,848	43,587	794,303	1,820,979	444,137
FY '17	907,368	1,096,478	41,968	799,755	1,866,307	445,329
FY '16	829,242	1,038,059	39,888	831,212	1,462,691	394,799

Table 4: Juror Utilization Pipeline Summary

Fiscal Year	Told to Report (%)	Sent for Selection (%)	Panel Used (%)	Juror Utilization (%)
FY '25	32.7	38.6	62.8	7.9
FY '24	32.7	37.1	63.3	7.7
FY '23	30.1	39.3	60.5	7.1
FY '22	28.4	34.0	63.6	6.1
FY '21	27.2	20.4	66.5	3.7
FY '20	31.1	37.1	62.2	7.2
FY '19	42.3	42.2	62.8	11.2
FY '18	44.7	40.3	62.7	11.3
FY '17	43.8	42.5	63.3	11.8
FY '16	51.8	41.9	64.6	14.0

Table 5: Panel Distribution by Case Type

Fiscal Year	Felony	Misdemeanor	Civil	Other
FY '25	6,369	2,894	3,383	95
FY '24	6,685	2,447	2,260	903
FY '23	6,384	3,219	2,104	191
FY '22	5,821	2,410	1,888	152
FY '21	4,496	1,368	526	227
FY '20	4,977	2,979	1,628	97
FY '19	6,942	4,321	2,324	134
FY '18	7,245	4,323	2,363	103
FY '17	7,188	4,388	2,603	124

FY '16	7,241	4,676	2,240	212
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Table 6: Sworn Jurors by Case Type

Fiscal Year	Felony	Misdemeanor	Civil	Other
FY '25	3,337	1,550	2,310	61
FY '24	3,342	1,566	1,466	576
FY '23	3,101	2,111	1,451	94
FY '22	2,379	1,633	1,185	86
FY '21	1,233	710	210	33
FY '20	2,970	2,352	1,228	64
FY '19	4,284	3,464	1,776	95
FY '18	4,561	3,485	1,847	83
FY '17	4,597	3,304	1,946	91
FY '16	4,455	3,560	1,774	140

Table 7: One-Day Jury Service by Modality

Fiscal Year	In-Person	Teleconference
FY '25	790,085	2,916,204
FY '24	791,424	3,336,895
FY '23	688,386	3,644,216
FY '22	505,620	3,547,501
FY '21	453,264	2,535,944
FY '20	626,085	3,218,413
FY '19	1,013,399	2,268,999
FY '18	1,001,772	2,158,264
FY '17	983,562	2,177,490
FY '16	938,260	1,535,325

Bibliography

- [1] P. Hannaford-Agor, M. Moffett, and B. Bell, “2023 State-of-the-States Survey of Jury Improvement Efforts,” 2024. [Online]. Available: <https://scholarship.law.wm.edu/facpubs/2373>